

Conservation

Despite the threats that animals face, habitats are being saved and species brought back from the edge of extinction. Conservation schemes safeguard wildlife, by protecting wild areas or breeding rare species.

Conservation in action

Today, national parks in Madagascar are helping protect the critically endangered greater bamboo lemur—one of the world's rarest primates. Reduced habitat destruction, daily monitoring, and local educational programs have been instituted to help save this rare species. This is just one example of how organizations all over the world have worked to save species since the 1960s.

Distinctive tufts

The greater bamboo lemur is recognizable by the white tufts around its ears.

IUCN Red List

A global body called the International Union for the Conservation of Nature (IUCN) keeps a Red List of Threatened Species. Each of the more than 120,000 species listed is assigned a threat level in order to figure out which ones need help most urgently.



Least concern

Unlikely to face extinction in the near future



Near threatened

Close to a threat of extinction in the near future



Vulnerable

Faces a high risk of extinction in the wild



Endangered

Faces a very high risk of extinction in the wild



Critically endangered

Faces an extremely high extinction risk in the wild



Extinct in the wild

Survives only in captivity or far outside its natural range



Extinct

Very likely that the last individual has died

Rainforest reliance

This species relies on rainforest where giant bamboo grows. The bamboo, which makes up 95 percent of its diet, is being lost in forest clearance.